Year 8 Admission Assessment

Name	
Date	

Welcome

These activities help us get to know you.

Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question.

- **Read** each question carefully.
- In **Maths** and **Science**, you can ask your teacher to read a question to you.
- In **Listening**, **Reading** and **Writing**, your teacher cannot explain words. We want to see your English.
- You need a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. You cannot use a calculator.

How to answer

Tick a box.

Which one is a city?

- ☐ apple
- ☑ Shanghai
- ☐ green

Write in a box.

7 + 5 = 12

Show your working.

25 × 12

Working

25 × 10 = 250

25 × 2 = 50

Answer 300

The parts of this paper

Part	What you do	Time
Listening	Listen to two students talking. Answer 8 questions.	5 minutes
Reading	Read three texts. Answer the questions.	12 minutes
Writing	Choose one task. Write about 20 lines.	10 minutes
Break	Have a short rest.	5 minutes
Maths	Answer the questions in Section A and Section B.	20 minutes
Science	Answer 7 questions.	8 minutes
Talk	Read some sentences aloud. Talk with a teacher about yourself and your plans.	15 minutes

Listening

Your teacher will read a conversation **two times**.

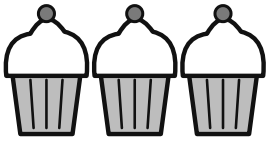
Two students, Mei and Amir, are talking about the school charity fair.

Read the questions now. Then **listen** and **answer** the questions.

1 / 1

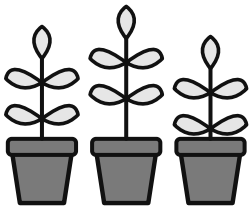
What will the class sell at the fair? **Tick** one box.

A



cakes ☐

B



plants ☐

C

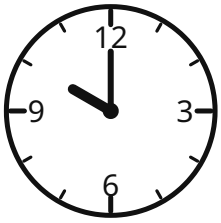


books ☐

2 / 1

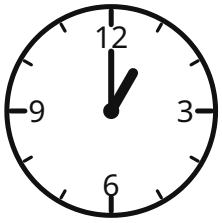
What time does the fair finish? **Tick** one box.

A



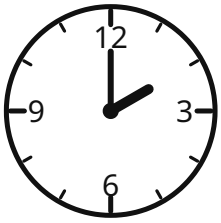
10:00 ☐

B



1:00 ☐

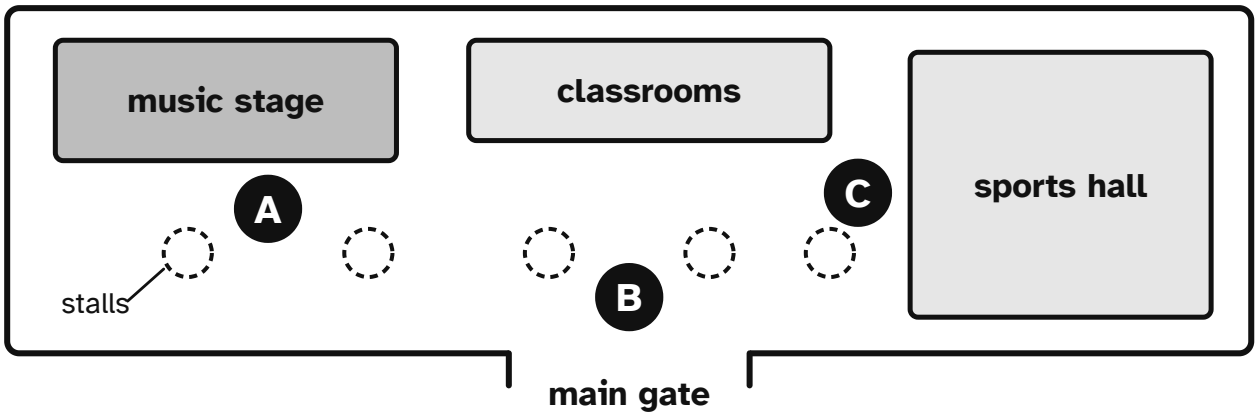
C



2:00 ☐

3 / 1

Where is the class stall this year? **Tick** one box.



☐ A ☐ B ☐ C

4 / 1

What will Amir do? **Tick** two boxes.

☐ make the price signs ☐ buy the plants ☐ bring a table ☐ play the piano

5 / 1

How many plants will Mei's aunt give the class? **Write** the number in the box.

☐

6 / 1

The class sells all the plants. How much money will they give to the charity? **Write** the number in the box.

☐ yuan

7 / 1

Amir will leave the fair before it finishes. Why? **Write** your answer.

8 / 1

Why is the main gate a better place for the stall than last year's place? **Write** one reason.

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Reading

Read the texts and **answer** the questions.

Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.

You have 12 minutes.

Part A: A notice

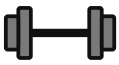
Read the notice. Then **answer** questions 1 to 6.

Greenway Sports Centre

Opening times

Monday to Friday	**7:00 to 21:00**
Saturday and Sunday	**8:00 to 18:00**

Prices

	**Swimming pool**	Adults: 30 yuan Students: 15 yuan
	**Badminton court**	40 yuan for one hour
	**Gym**	25 yuan Age 16 and over only

Students: please show your student card.

Lockers: you need a 2 yuan coin.

No food or drink in the pool area.

1 / 1

What time does the sports centre open on Saturday? **Write** your answer in the box.

2 / 1

How much is a swimming ticket for a student? **Write** your answer in the box.

3 / 1

Who can use the gym? **Write** your answer in the box.

4 / 1

What do you need to use a locker? **Write** your answer in the box.

5 / 3

Tick True or False for each sentence.

Example	True	False
The centre has a gym.	✓	

Sentence	True	False
a. The centre closes at 21:00 on Sunday.	☐	☐
b. A badminton court costs 40 yuan for one hour.	☐	☐
c. You can eat a snack in the pool area.	☐	☐

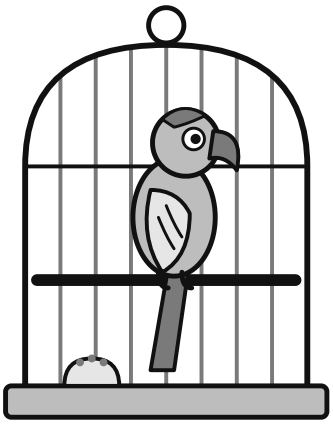
6 / 1

Li Na and Jun are 13. They both want to swim. They show their student cards. How much do they pay altogether? **Write** your answer in the box.

Part B: A story

Read the story. Then **answer** questions 7 to 13.

Lulu Learns a Word



Zhang Wei's aunt was going away for a week, so Zhang Wei looked after her parrot, Lulu. Lulu was green, with a red patch on her head. She lived in a big cage by the window.

"Lulu can say one word," said Auntie. "Hello. But she only talks when she is happy."

Every morning, Zhang Wei gave Lulu fresh water and seeds. Every evening, he cleaned her cage. But Lulu did not say a word. She just sat on her perch and watched him with her bright, round eyes.

"Maybe she misses Auntie," said Mum.

Zhang Wei had an idea. After school, he did his homework next to the cage. He read his English book out loud, and he told Lulu about his day.

On the sixth day, Zhang Wei was practising the flute. He played the same tune again and again, and every time he made the same mistake. "Oh no!" he said each time. "Oh no!"

Behind him, a small voice said, "Oh no!"

Zhang Wei spun round. Lulu was moving her head up and down. "Oh no! Oh no!" she said.

The next day, Auntie came home. Lulu looked at her and said, "Hello!" Then she looked at Zhang Wei and said, "Oh no!"

Auntie laughed so much that she had to sit down. "Well," she said, "I think she likes you."

7 / 1

What colour was Lulu? **Tick** one box.

☐ green ☐ red ☐ yellow

8 / 1

At the start of the story, what word could Lulu say? **Write** your answer in the box.

9 / 1

What did Zhang Wei give Lulu every morning? **Write** your answer.

10 / 2

Write the numbers 1, 2, 3 and 4 to show the order of the events in the story.

Event	Order
Lulu said "Oh no!" for the first time.	
Zhang Wei did his homework next to the cage.	
Auntie came home.	
Auntie went away.	

11 / 1

"Zhang Wei **spun round**." What does **spun round** mean here? **Tick** one box.

☐ turned round quickly ☐ fell over ☐ ran away

12 / 1

Why did Lulu start to say "Oh no!"? **Write** your answer.

13 / 1

Auntie says, "I think she likes you." Why do you think she says this? **Write** your answer.

Part C: An article

Read the article. Then **answer** questions 14 to 20.

Sleep: why teenagers need more of it

If you find it hard to get up for school, you are not lazy. You are probably just a teenager.

Scientists who study sleep have found that the body clock changes in the early teenage years. This clock is controlled partly by melatonin, a chemical that makes us feel sleepy. In younger children, the body releases melatonin early in the evening. In teenagers, it is released up to two hours later. This means that a thirteen-year-old may not feel tired until eleven o'clock at night, even though they will be exhausted when the alarm rings the next morning.

At the same time, teenagers need a lot of sleep: between eight and ten hours a night, according to most sleep experts. Their bodies and brains are still developing, and much of this happens while they sleep. During deep sleep, the brain also sorts and stores what we have learnt during the day. So a student who sleeps well after studying is likely to remember more than a student who stays up late to study for longer.

Unfortunately, modern life makes good sleep harder. Phones and tablets give out a kind of blue light that tells the brain it is still daytime, and messages and videos keep the mind busy. Many students also have long days, with homework and extra classes in the evening.

So what can you do? Sleep experts suggest a few simple habits. Go to bed and get up at about the same time every day, even at weekends. Put your phone in another room an hour before bed. Keep your bedroom cool, dark and quiet. If something is worrying you, write it down before you sleep, so your mind can let it go until the morning.

Some schools around the world have started the school day later, and many report that their students are more alert in lessons. Until that happens everywhere, the best thing you can do is protect your own sleep. Your brain will thank you.

14 / 1

How many hours of sleep do teenagers need, according to the article? **Write** your answer in the box.

15 / 1

Why might a thirteen-year-old not feel sleepy at ten o'clock at night? **Write** your answer.

16 / 1

"They will be **exhausted** when the alarm rings." What does **exhausted** mean? **Tick** one box.

☐ very tired ☐ very hungry ☐ very late ☐ very happy

17 / 2

Which two pieces of advice are in the article? **Tick** two boxes.

☐ Drink a glass of warm milk before bed.
☐ Go to bed at about the same time every day.
☐ Study late at night before a test.
☐ Put your phone in another room an hour before bed.
☐ Sleep with a light on.

18 / 1

The article says a student who sleeps well after studying will probably remember more. Why? **Write** your answer.

19 / 1

The writer begins: "If you find it hard to get up for school, you are not lazy." Why do you think the writer begins like this? **Write** your answer.

20 / 1

What is the main purpose of the article? **Tick** one box.

☐ to tell a funny story ☐ to explain a problem and give advice

☐ to sell a new phone ☐ to complain about schools

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Writing

You have 10 minutes.

Choose one task. **Tick** the box for your task.

☐ **Task 1: A description**	☐ **Task 2: A speech**
Describe a busy place you know well. For example: a train station at Spring Festival, a night market, or a sports match.	Many students throw away food in the school canteen. **Write** a speech for your class. Persuade students to waste less food.
Ideas: What can you see, hear and smell? Who is there? How does it make you feel?	Ideas: Why is wasting food a problem? What can students do? Use strong reasons and examples.

Plan your writing in the box. You can write notes.

Plan

Write your answer on the lines. Try to write about 20 lines.

Check your writing: capital letters, full stops, spelling. Does it make sense?

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Maths

You have 20 minutes. You cannot use a calculator.

You can ask your teacher to read a question to you.

Show your working. You can get marks for your working.

Section A: Number problems

Work out the answers. **Write** each answer in the box.

1 / 1

$3.7 + 12.45 =$ ☐

2 / 2

a. $-8 + 3 =$ ☐

b. $(-4) \times (-6) =$ ☐

3 / 1

Write the highest common factor (HCF) of 18 and 24.

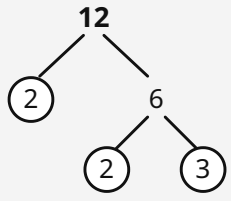
☐

4 / 1

Write 60 as a product of prime factors.

Example:

$12 = 2 \times 2 \times 3$



Working

$60 =$ ☐

5 / 1

$\frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{4} =$ ☐

6 / 2

a. **Simplify** $3a + 5b - a + 2b$

☐

b. $a = 5$ and $b = -2$. **Work out** $3a + 4b$

☐

7 / 1

Solve $5x - 7 = 18$

$x =$ ☐

8 / 1

Solve $4x + 3 = x + 15$

$x =$ ☐

Working

Section B: Word problems and pictures

9 / 1

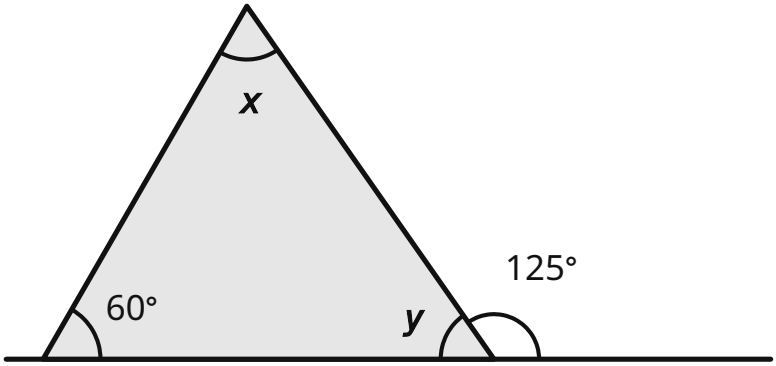
At 6 am, the temperature in Harbin was –18 °C.

By midday, it was 7 degrees warmer.

What was the temperature at midday?

☐ °C

10 / 2



Not drawn accurately

The bottom side of the triangle is part of a straight line. **Work out** angle *y* and angle *x*.

y = ☐ ° *x* = ☐ °

11 / 3

All the corners are right angles.

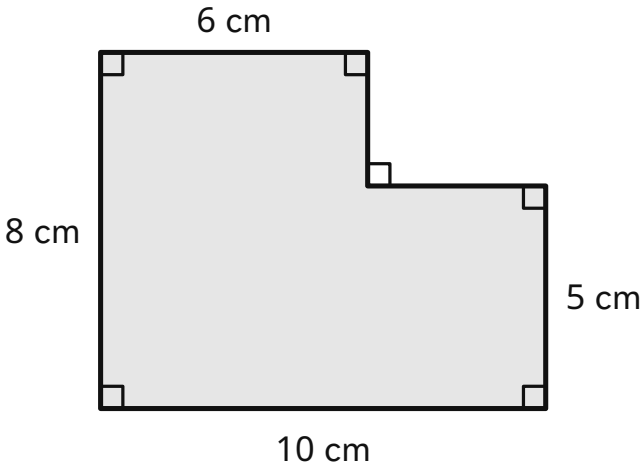
Tick the correct unit for each answer.

a. **Work out** the area of the shape.

☐ ☐cm ☐cm² ☐cm³

b. **Work out** the perimeter of the shape.

☐ ☐cm ☐cm² ☐cm³



Not drawn accurately

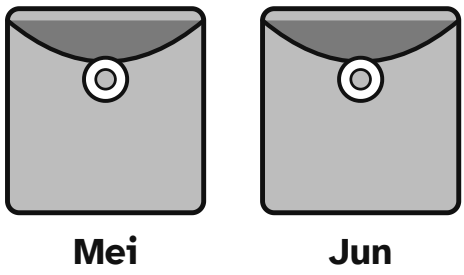
12 / 2

Grandma gives Mei and Jun 120 yuan.

They share it in the ratio 3 : 5.

Mei gets the smaller share.

How much does each person get?



Mei ☐ yuan

Jun ☐ yuan

13 / 1

Bus A leaves the bus station every 6 minutes.

Bus B leaves the bus station every 8 minutes.

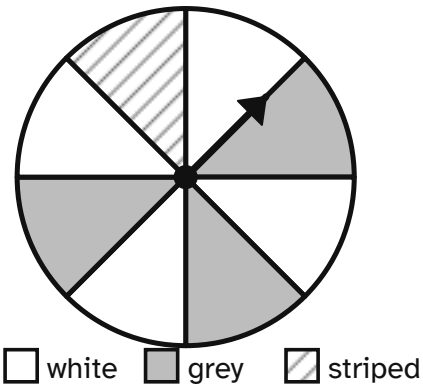
Both buses leave at 8:00.

When will they next leave at the same time?

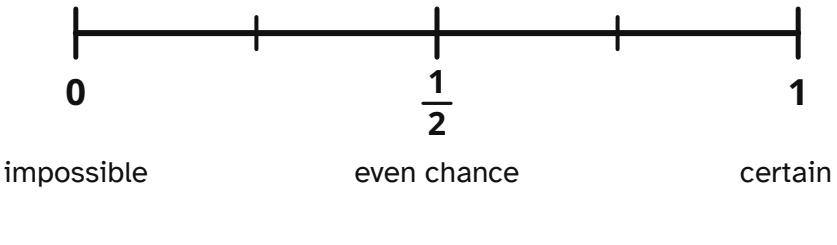
☐

14 / 2

Here is a spinner with 8 equal parts.



Probability scale



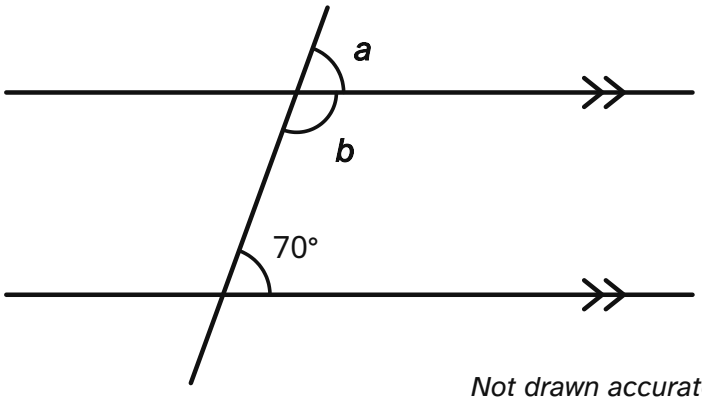
An event that will **certainly** happen has a probability of 1.

a. **Draw** an arrow on the probability scale to show the probability that the spinner lands on **white**.

b. **Write** the probability that the spinner lands on **grey**. ☐

15

/ 2



Not drawn accurately

The two lines with arrows are parallel. **Work out** angle *a* and angle *b*.

a = ☐ ° *b* = ☐ °

16

/ 1

40 students travel to school.

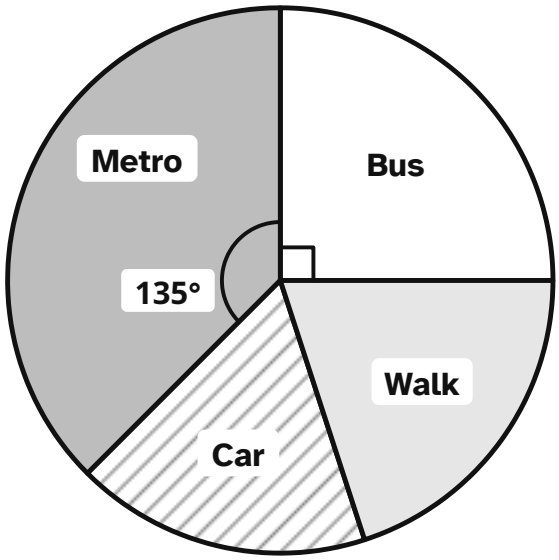
The pie chart shows how they travel.

The angle for metro is 135°.

How many students travel by metro?

Working

☐



17

/ 2

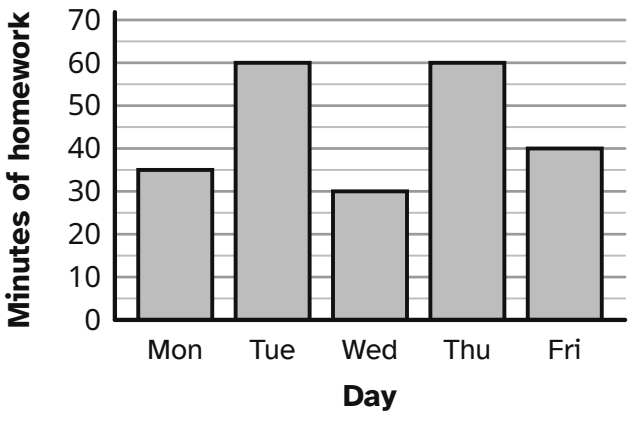
The bar chart shows how many minutes Zhang Wei spent on homework each day.

Work out each answer in minutes.

Mode ☐ Median ☐

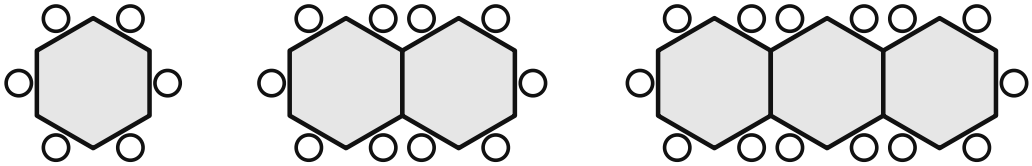
Range ☐ Mean ☐

Working



18 / 2

Hexagon tables are put in a row. A chair goes at every free side.



1 table
6 chairs

2 tables
10 chairs

3 tables
14 chairs

a. How many chairs are needed for 10 tables in a row? ☐

b. **Write** a rule for the number of chairs for *n* tables in a row.

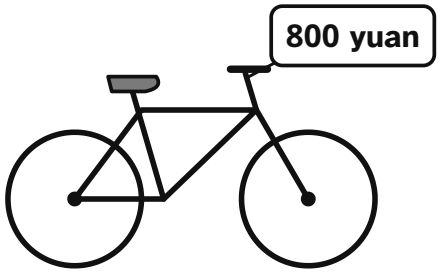
Number of chairs = ☐

19 / 2

A bike costs 800 yuan.

Next month, the price will go up by 15%.

What will the new price be?



Working

☐ yuan

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

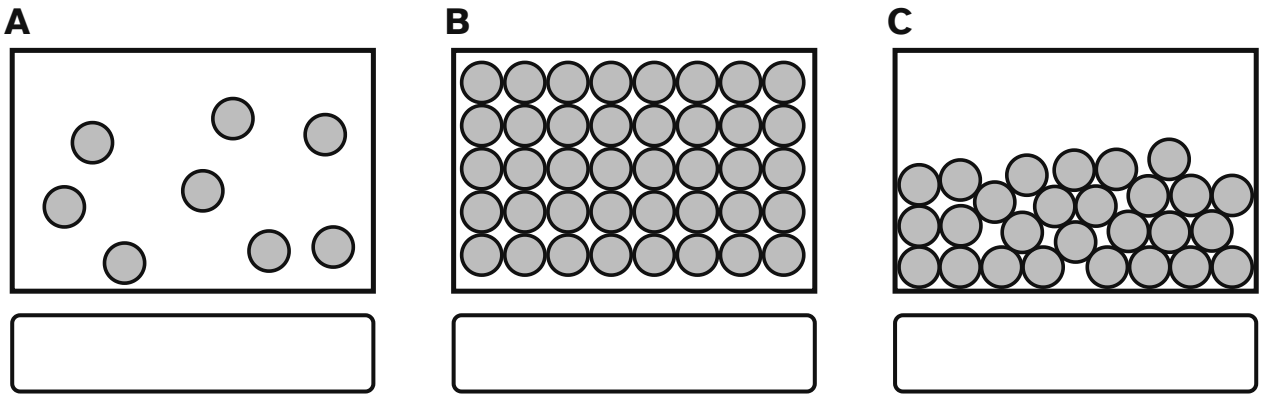
Science

You have 8 minutes.

You can ask your teacher to read a question to you.

1 / 2

a. **Write** solid, liquid or gas in the box under each picture.

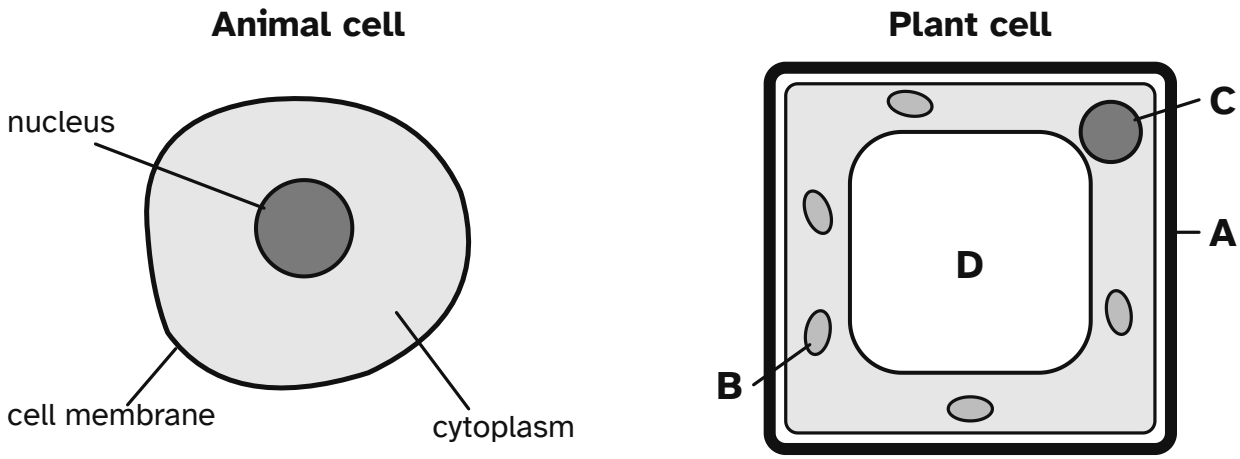


b. Ice is heated and it melts. What happens to the energy of its particles? **Tick** one box.

☐ It increases. ☐ It decreases. ☐ It stays the same.

2 / 1

Mei looks at cells with a microscope. She draws an animal cell and a plant cell.



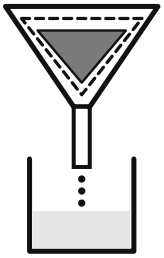
Write the letter of one part that the plant cell has and the animal cell does **not** have.

3 / 1

Aisha has a mixture of sand and salt. She wants to get dry salt.

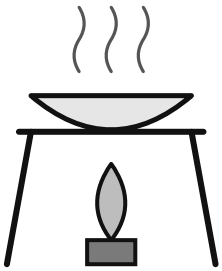
Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to put the steps in order.

A



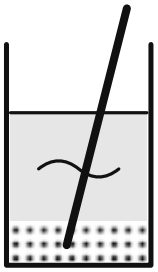
filter

B



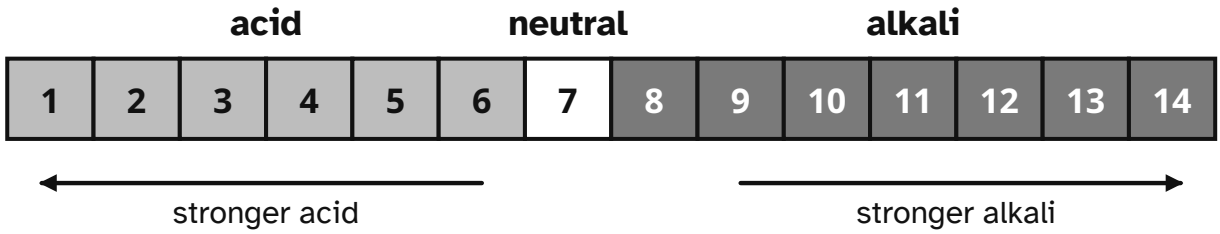
evaporate

C



add water and stir

4 / 2

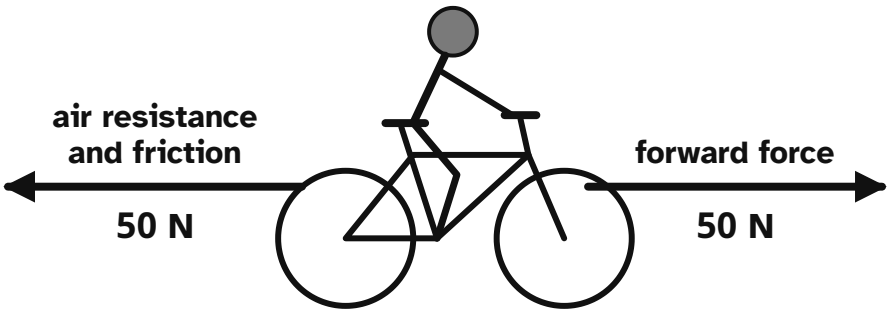


Substance	lemon juice	vinegar	pure water	toothpaste	soap
pH	2	3	7	9	10

a. Which substance in the table is the strongest acid? _____

b. **Write** the name of one alkali in the table. _____

5 / 2



a. The two forces are balanced. What happens to the girl's speed? **Tick** one box.

☐ It goes up. ☐ It stays the same. ☐ It goes down.

b. She travels 100 m in 20 seconds. **Work out** her speed.

speed = distance ÷ time ☐ m/s

6 / 1

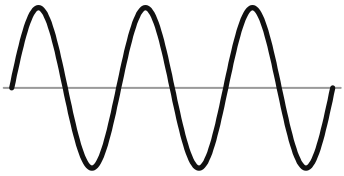
These pictures show three sound waves. Which one is the **loudest** sound? **Tick** one box.

A



☐

B



☐

C



☐

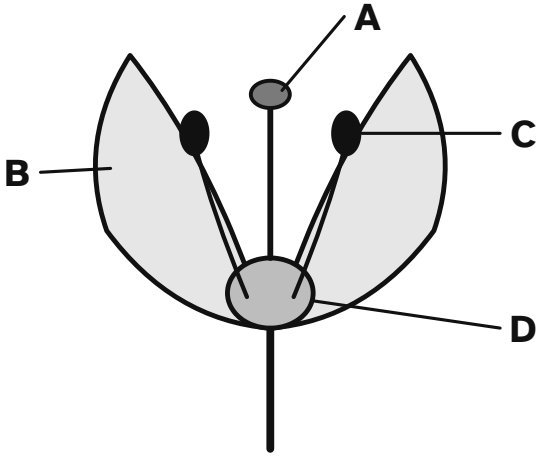
7 / 1

This picture shows the parts of a flower.

Which part makes **pollen**?

Write the letter in the box.

☐



Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 8 Admission Assessment: assessor booklet

For students applying to join **Year 8** (age 12 to 13 on 1 September). A Year 8 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 6** (the end of primary school) and is the same age as a student starting Grade 7 (初一). The maths paper tests UK Year 7 content, so algebraic manipulation, operations with negative numbers, angle rules with parallel lines, probability as a number, and the median, mode and range **may not have been taught yet**. A Year 8 entrant has usually done **no secondary science**: the science paper tests UK Year 7 content, so read the science score with the NT notes in Section 5. Background, the English bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Notes
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	Student paper, pencil, rubber, ruler	Script in Section 2
2	Listening (paper pages 2 to 3)	5	Assessor reads the script twice	This booklet, Section 3.1	A conversation: you read both voices. Can be done with a small group
3	Reading paper (pages 4 to 9)	12	Student works alone; assessor times	Clock or timer	Do not read the texts aloud
4	Writing (pages 10 to 11)	10	Student works alone		Choose one of two tasks
5	Break	3 to 5		Water	
6	Maths (pages 12 to 16)	20	Student; assessor may read questions aloud	No calculator, no protractor	Section A number problems, Section B word problems and pictures
7	Science (pages 17 to 19)	8	Student; assessor may read questions aloud		
8	Interview, opening with sentence reading	15	Interviewer, 1:1	`forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, a plain card	Sentence reading starts at **Level 7** (sentence 19)
	Total	**about 70**			Plus the parent conversation (about 15 minutes, separate)

Print for each candidate: the Year 8 student paper (19 pages, A4), the interview record (Years 7 to 10), the sentence reading record, the parent conversation record and the candidate summary. **Print once per room:** this booklet and the sentence reading card (laminate it). The score summary (Section 6) can be copied, one per candidate.

2. Before you start

Welcome script. Say, in a calm, friendly voice:

> "Hello, I'm … . Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities in English: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and find the right support for you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best, and it is OK if you cannot

answer everything. In maths and science I can read a question to you. In the English parts I cannot explain words, because we want to see your English. You can always ask me to say an instruction again. Do you have any questions?"

Access rules (the same in every year group; details in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 7)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate or read the reading texts aloud. You may repeat instructions in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as asked, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff. All answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Mark the question **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Answers must be in English; an answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics in the score summary.

- **Extra time or a reader** for a known need is allowed; record it in the score summary.
- **Stopping.** The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. In the reading paper, Part C is meant to stretch: if the student is clearly stuck after Part B, let them stop and say "Thank you, that is fine." In writing, if the student cannot write in English, ask them to write any words they know, or a plan; do not score Chinese writing, but keep it. Never push a distressed student: take a break or stop, and record it.
- **Keeping the student at ease.** Explain the order of the morning and the break. Sit beside, not opposite, for the interview. Praise effort, not answers ("Thank you, you are working hard"). Do not show surprise at mistakes. Keep the timer out of the student's line of sight, and give a calm two-minute warning near the end of each timed part. Many Year 8 students have just left primary school: tell them the science has topics they may not have studied yet, and that this is expected.

3. English

3.1 Listening (5 minutes, 8 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Listening page. I am going to read a conversation between two students, Mei and Amir. I will read it two times. First, read the questions." Give the student **one minute** to look at all eight questions (pages 2 and 3). Then say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at a natural, steady pace. You read both parts. Say the speaker's name before each turn, a little more quietly, and make the two voices slightly different. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish. Do not repeat any part, and do not explain any word.

Script: Mei and Amir talk about the charity fair

Amir: Mei, have you decided what our class is going to sell at the charity fair?

Mei: Yes! We wanted to sell cakes, but the Year 9 classes are already doing that. So we're going to sell plants instead: small ones, in pots. **[pause]**

Amir: Plants? OK. When is the fair? Is it this Friday?

Mei: No, it's next Saturday, from ten in the morning until two in the afternoon. **[pause]**

Amir: And where is our stall? Next to the music stage again?

Mei: No. Last year it was so loud there that nobody could hear us. This year we're by the main gate. **[pause]**

Amir: What can I do to help?

Mei: Can you make the price signs? You're much better at drawing than me. And Ms Chen says every class needs its own table. Can you bring one?

Amir: Sure. I'll do the signs this weekend, and I'll ask my dad about a table. He's got a folding one at home. **[pause]**

Mei: Thank you!

Amir: Where will we get the plants?

Mei: My aunt has a flower shop. She'll give us forty plants for 200 yuan. **[pause]**

Amir: And how much will we sell them for?

Mei: Ten yuan each. If we sell all of them, we'll get 400 yuan. After we pay my aunt, there will be 200 yuan for the charity. **[pause]**

Amir: Great. Oh, but I can only come in the morning. I have a piano lesson at one o'clock. **[pause]**

Mei: That's fine. And I'm really happy about the main gate.

Amir: Me too. Everybody will walk past us when they come in!

Answers. One mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** plants		A (cakes): heard "cakes" but missed "but the Year 9 classes are already doing that".
2	**C** 2:00		A (10:00) is the start; B (1:00) is Amir's piano lesson.
3	**B** (by the main gate)		A: last year's place, next to the music stage.
4	**Both** make the price signs **and** bring a table		One correct only, or three or more ticked: 0. "Buy the plants" (the aunt gives them) and "play the piano" (his lesson) are distractors.
5	**40**	forty	200 (the cost).
6	**200**	200 yuan, ¥200	400: heard the takings but not "after we pay my aunt".
7	He has a piano lesson at one o'clock (and the fair goes on until two).	He has a piano lesson; he has to go to piano.	"He is drawing the signs"; "He is busy" with no reason.
8	Everybody walks past the main gate when they come in, so more people will see the stall.	It is not next to the music stage, so it is quieter and people can hear them; more customers.	"Because it is near the gate" with no reason; "because it is big".

Band guide (listening, / 8): 0 to 2 **A** · 3 to 4 **B** · 5 to 6 **C** · 7 **D** · 8 **E**

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 4 each have a distractor that is mentioned in the conversation. Choosing the distractor every time shows a listener catching single words, not following the exchange: typical of band B.
- Question 6 needs the student to hear a correction ("after we pay my aunt"); questions 7 and 8 need inference across two turns. A fluent Year 8 listener answers both quickly.
- **English barrier or something else?** A conversation is harder than a single speaker because the student must track who says what. If a student scores low here but understood you well in conversation, note it and compare with the interview.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, 24 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading pages. Read the texts and answer the questions. There are three parts. They get harder. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Start the timer. Do not read the texts or questions aloud, and do not explain words. You may repeat this instruction. Give a two-minute warning.

Mark scheme. Spelling and grammar are not marked in reading answers if the meaning is clear. Answers copied from the text are fine when they answer the question. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: Greenway Sports Centre (a notice; very accessible, with pictures)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	8:00	8, 8 am, eight o'clock	7:00 (the weekday time)
2	15 yuan	15, ¥15	30
3	People aged 16 and over	16 and over; over 16; 16+; people who are 16 or older	"Adults" (not what the notice says); "students"
4	A 2 yuan coin	2 yuan; a coin	"A student card"
5	a False · b True · c False		1 mark for each correct row (3 marks)
6	30 yuan	30, ¥30, 15 + 15	15 (one ticket); 60 (adult price)

Part B: Lulu Learns a Word (fiction, about two years below age level)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
7	green		red (the patch on her head)
8	Hello	"Hello" in any spelling that is clear	"Oh no" (the word she learns later)
9	Fresh water and seeds	water; seeds; food; water and food	"He cleaned her cage" (that was every evening)
10	Lulu said "Oh no!" for the first time **3** · Zhang Wei did his homework next to the cage **2** · Auntie came home **4** · Auntie went away **1**		**2 marks** for all four correct. **1 mark** if only two events next to each other in the story are swapped.
11	turned round quickly		
12	She heard Zhang Wei say "Oh no!" again and again, and she copied him.	She copied Zhang Wei; she learnt it from Zhang Wei; Zhang Wei kept saying it when he made a mistake	"Because she was sad"; "because she made a mistake"
13	Lulu only talks when she is happy, and now she talks to Zhang Wei (she learnt a word from him), so she must be happy with him.	She learnt his words because he spent time with her; she talks to him now; she was happy with him; she said a word to him	"Because Lulu said hello" with no link to Zhang Wei; "because she is funny"

Part C: Sleep: why teenagers need more of it (non-fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 12)

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
14	Retrieval	8 to 10 hours	between eight and ten hours	13; "a lot"
15	Inference	Teenagers' bodies release melatonin (the chemical that makes us sleepy) later, up to two hours later.	Their body clock changes; the sleepy chemical comes later; blue light from phones tells the brain it is still daytime	"They are lazy"; "they have homework" with no link to feeling sleepy
16	Vocabulary in context	very tired		
17	Retrieval (2)	Go to bed at about the same time every day · Put your phone in another room an hour before bed		**1 mark for each correct tick.** Take off 1 mark for each wrong tick beyond two boxes (minimum 0).

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
18	Inference	During deep sleep, the brain sorts and stores what we have learnt.	Sleep helps the brain save or keep information; the brain organises learning while you sleep	"Because they are not tired" with no link to memory
19	Author's purpose	To make teenage readers feel understood (it is not their fault), so they want to read on.	To get the reader's attention; to speak directly to the reader; to surprise the reader; to show it is about biology, not being lazy	"Because teenagers are lazy"
20	Author's purpose	to explain a problem and give advice		

Band guide (reading paper). Use the part scores, in this order:

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B**
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C**
Part C 3 to 5	**D**
Part C 6 to 8	**E**

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example a high Part C with a low Part B, which can happen when a student ran out of time or misread one instruction), and check against the sentence reading screen in the interview.

What to look for

- Strong readers answer Part C questions 15, 18 and 19 in their own words and explain the writer's choices. Weaker readers copy a sentence near the key word whether or not it answers the question.
- Part C is a non-fiction article with subject vocabulary (melatonin, releases, developing, alert). Students from Chinese schools often know the science in Chinese; vocabulary, not the idea, is usually the barrier.
- **English barrier or reading difficulty?** If a student reads aloud fluently in the sentence reading screen but scores low here, the gap is vocabulary and comprehension, not decoding. If a student is slow and inaccurate in both, and also reads slowly in Chinese (ask the parents), note a possible reading difficulty.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task and tick it. Plan in the box first. Then write. Try to write about 20 lines. You have 10 minutes." You may repeat the instruction. Do not explain the prompts.

The tasks

- **Task 1 (descriptive):** describe a busy place you know well, for example a train station at Spring Festival, a night market or a sports match.
- **Task 2 (persuasive):** a speech to the class persuading students to waste less food in the school canteen.

Marking. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 are between the descriptions). Total / 16. Then give the band by **best fit** with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, using the total only as a check.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or isolated words; no link to the task.	A short response that follows the task; a list of things seen, or of reasons, with simple links ("and", "also"); little development; little paragraphing.	Well shaped for the age: the description builds a clear picture through the senses and has a focus (a moment, a mood); the speech has a clear position, two or three developed reasons with examples, a call to action and an awareness of the audience ("we", "you"); paragraphs.

Criterion	0	2	4
Vocabulary	Single memorised words or copied words.	Everyday words used correctly; some repetition; gaps filled with simple words or Chinese.	A wide range, chosen for effect: precise nouns, verbs and adjectives in the description; persuasive language in the speech (rhetorical questions, "imagine", "surely", "every day we ..."); words for linking ideas.
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Simple sentences and some joined with "and", "but", "because"; frequent errors (verb tenses, plurals, articles, word order) but meaning is mostly clear.	Varied sentences, including complex ones and some for effect (a short sentence after a long one, a list of three); tenses controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling makes most words hard to read; no punctuation.	Common words spelt correctly; longer words phonetically plausible; full stops and capital letters used, not always correctly.	Accurate spelling, including most longer words; sentence punctuation secure; commas in lists and after openings, question and exclamation marks, apostrophes mostly correct.

Rough guide to the total (best fit decides): 0 to 3 **A** · 4 to 7 **B** · 8 to 10 **C** · 11 to 13 **D** · 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E writing at Year 8. Comparable to a fluent writer of 12 or 13. In 10 minutes, usually 180 to 280 words in clear paragraphs. The description goes beyond a list: it uses the senses, chooses details and creates an atmosphere. The speech addresses its audience, argues with reasons and examples and ends with a clear call to action. Sentences are varied and controlled, vocabulary is precise and sometimes ambitious, and errors are few and minor. Judge quality, not just length.

What to look for

- Typical features of Chinese-speaking learners (missing past tense -ed or plural -s, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed, "very" for every intensifier) are normal stages of learning English. Score them under grammar, but read past them to judge content.
- Memorised phrases from textbooks or exam practice ("As we all know", "In a word", "Last but not least") are common: they show learning, but judge the writing on what the student does with them.
- Writing much weaker than speaking is common in students from oral-heavy English courses; writing much stronger than speaking is common in students taught mainly through grammar and textbook dialogues.

3.4 Speaking and sentence reading (the interview, 15 minutes)

The interview is 1:1 and uses **`forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`**. It opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen** (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Record` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`): for Year 8, **start at Level 7 (sentence 19)**, and follow the rules on the record for going back, stopping, the meaning checks and fluency. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Then use the interview questions (school and learning, interests, friends and wellbeing, future plans and aspirations, values, an opinion question) and give the **speaking band** with the descriptors on the interview record. Copy the sentence reading total, reading age and the speaking band into the score summary.

The interview record's opinion questions (homework, phones) do not overlap with the writing tasks above.

4. Maths (20 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths pages. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and problems with pictures. You cannot use a calculator. Show your working in the boxes: you can get marks for your working. I can read any question to you. Just ask. You have 20 minutes."

Read any question aloud on request, as often as asked, and point to the picture. Follow the access rules (Section 2): mark **L** if a Chinese-speaking colleague gave a question once in Chinese, and **NT** if the student says they have not learnt the topic.

Marking. Accept any clear, correct method. Accept equivalent answers (for example 0.375 for 3/8) unless the question says otherwise. Where units are printed on the paper, a missing unit does not lose a mark (question 11

tests units on purpose). Where a method mark is shown, give it for a correct method with one arithmetic slip.

Section A: Number problems (10 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	16.15	1	12.82 means the decimal points were not lined up.	Decimals (floor item)
2	a –5 · b 24	1 + 1	a: 5 or –11 are sign errors. b: –24 means the rule for two negatives is not known.	Operations with negative numbers
3	6	1	2 or 3 are common factors but not the highest; 72 is the lowest common multiple.	HCF
4	2 × 2 × 3 × 5	1	$2^2 \times 3 \times 5$, in any order. Not 4 × 3 × 5 (4 is not prime) or 2 × 30.	Prime factorisation
5	11/12	1	3/7 means the student added tops and bottoms.	Adding fractions
6	a $2a + 7b$ · b 7	1 + 1	a: $7b + 2a$. b: 15 + (–8) = 7. 23 means b was taken as +2.	Simplifying expressions; substitution
7	$x = 5$	1		Solving a linear equation
8	$x = 4$	1	$3x = 12$. 6 or 4.5 show errors in collecting terms.	Unknowns on both sides (Year 8 content: ceiling item)

Section B: Word problems and pictures (20 marks). W = word problem (6 marks in all).

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
9 **W**	–11 (°C)	1	One-step, measures. 11, –25 or 25 show sign errors.	Negative numbers in context
10	$y = 55$, $x = 65$ (degrees)	1 + 1	*x*: follow through from a wrong *y*: give the mark for 120 – (their *y*).	Angles on a straight line; angles in a triangle (floor item)
11	a 68 · b 36 · units cm^2 for a and cm for b	1 + 1 + 1	a: 80 forgot the missing corner; 48 or 20 is one rectangle only. b: 29 adds only the four labelled sides (the missing sides are 3 cm and 4 cm). Units mark: both correct boxes ticked.	Area of a compound shape; perimeter; units
12 **W**	Mei 45, Jun 75 (yuan)	2	Two-step, money. **1 mark** for 120 ÷ 8 = 15 seen, or one share correct, or both correct but the wrong way round. 40 and 80 means the ratio was read as 1 : 2 or divided by 3.	Sharing in a ratio
13 **W**	8:24	1	Time. 24 minutes later; 08:24; 8.24. 8:48 is a common multiple but not the lowest. 8:14 added 6 and 8.	LCM
14	a an arrow at 1/2 · b 3/8	1 + 1	a: the arrow is clearly at the middle mark. b: 0.375, 37.5%. "3 out of 8" scores but note the notation; 3 : 8 or 3 : 5 score 0.	Probability on a 0 to 1 scale
15	$a = 70$, $b = 110$ (degrees)	1 + 1	a: corresponding angles. b: angles on a straight line (or co-interior angles); follow through 180 – (their *a*).	Angles and parallel lines
16	15	1	135 ÷ 360 × 40, or 135 ÷ 9 (each student is 9°).	Pie charts
17	mode 60 · median 40 · range 30 · mean 45 (minutes)	2	**2** for all four; **1** for two or three. Median 30 means the student did not put the values in order; range 60 is the largest value only; mean 225 is the total.	Mean, median, mode and range; bar charts
18	a 42 · b $4n + 2$	1 + 1	b: $4 \times n + 2$, $2 + 4n$, "multiply by 4 and add 2". a: 60 (10 × 6) means joined sides were not taken into account. "Add 4" scores 0 in b but note it.	Sequences and the nth term (b is a ceiling item)
19 **W**	920 (yuan)	2	Multi-step, money and percentages. **1 mark** for 120 seen (15% of 800), or for 800 × 1.15 with an arithmetic slip. 120 as the final answer scores 1. 815 scores 0.	Percentage of an amount; percentage increase (Year 8 content: ceiling item)

Totals: Section A / 10 · Section B / 20 · **of which word problems / 6** (questions 9, 12, 13 and 19).

Band guide (maths, / 30; provisional): 0 to 11 **1** Well below expected · 12 to 17 **2** Working towards · 18 to 25 **3** Expected · 26 to 30 **4** Greater depth. List NT questions, and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

May not have been taught. A Year 8 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed Grade 6 (PEP sequence; other textbooks differ a little, so ask the student). These topics are usually taught in Grade 7 (初一) or later, or are not in every textbook, so the student **may not have been taught** them:

Questions	Topic	Usually taught in China
2, 6b, 9	Calculating with negative numbers (negative numbers are introduced in Grade 6)	Grade 7
4	Prime factorisation as a product (primes and factors are Grade 5; the factor tree may be new)	Grade 5 in some textbooks; optional in others
6	Simplifying expressions (letters for numbers is Grade 5)	Grade 7
8	Equations with the unknown on both sides (simple equations are Grade 5)	Grade 7
14	Probability as a number (likelihood in words is Grade 5)	Grade 9
15	Angle rules with parallel lines	Grade 7
17	Median, mode and range (the mean is Grade 4)	Grade 8
18b	A rule for the nth term (pattern spotting is common)	Not taught formally

Usually **familiar**: decimals and fractions, HCF and LCM (Grade 5), area and perimeter including compound shapes (Grades 3 to 5), angles on a straight line and in a triangle (Grade 4), ratio, percentages and pie charts (Grade 6).

What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** Compare Section A with the word problems (W). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an **English barrier** rather than a maths difficulty. Check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the student then solves it, record that the barrier is English. Questions 9 and 2a are a direct pair (negative numbers with and without words).
- Strong students show clear methods, use the angle facts confidently and get the ceiling items (8, 18b, 19). Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately but write little working: that is fine when the answer is right.
- A low score that is mostly Grade 7 algebra and geometry (2, 6, 8, 15) or statistics (14, 17) is very different from a low score on taught topics (1, 3, 5, 11, 12, 16). Say which in the summary.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science pages. There are 7 questions. Some topics may be new to you: that is fine, do what you can. I can read any question to you. You have 8 minutes." The same access rules as maths apply (L and NT). Spelling does not matter in science answers if the word is recognisable.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	a A gas · B solid · C liquid · b It increases.	1 + 1	a: all three for the mark.	The particle model; energy and changes of state
2	A, B or D	1	The name instead of the letter (cell wall, chloroplast, vacuole). C (the nucleus) scores 0: both cells have one.	Animal and plant cells (the picture gives the comparison)
3	C 1 · A 2 · B 3	1	All three for the mark: dissolve, filter, evaporate. A, C, B (filter first) shows the student has not thought about the salt being dissolved.	Separating mixtures; a method in order (working scientifically)
4	a lemon juice · b toothpaste or soap	1 + 1	a: vinegar is an acid but not the strongest. b: pure water is neutral.	Acids, alkalis and the pH scale; reading a table

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
5	a It stays the same. · b 5 (m/s)	1 + 1	a: "it goes down" is a very common idea (that motion needs an unbalanced force). b: 2000 means distance × time.	Balanced forces; speed = distance ÷ time
6	B	1	C (the most waves) means the student confused loudness with pitch.	Sound as a wave
7	C	1	The anther. A (the stigma) receives pollen.	Reproduction in plants

Band guide (science, / 10; provisional): 0 to 3 **1** · 4 to 5 **2** · 6 to 8 **3** · 9 to 10 **4**.

May not have been taught. A Year 8 entrant has usually done **no secondary science**: in Chinese schools biology starts in Grade 7 (初一), physics in Grade 8 and chemistry in Grade 9. Primary science (科学) covers some of these ideas, but textbooks differ. So a Year 8 entrant **may not have been taught**: the particle model and energy in changes of state (Q1; states of matter are usually familiar from primary science), the parts of plant and animal cells (Q2; microscopes and cells are often met in Grade 6), acids, alkalis and pH (Q4; chemistry, Grade 9), balanced forces and calculating speed (Q5; physics, Grade 8), and sound shown as a wave (Q6; sound and vibration are Grade 4). Separating mixtures by filtering and evaporating (Q3) and the parts of a flower (Q7) are often taught in primary science. Read a low science score with these notes, and judge the student's scientific thinking from questions 2, 3, 4 and 5b.

Not covered in this paper: energy stores and transfers are tested only through heating and changes of state (Q1b), and light waves are not tested, because 10 marks cannot cover every Year 7 topic.

What to look for

- Questions 2, 3 and 4 can be answered from the picture or the table with careful reading and reasoning, even if the topic is new: a student who gets them is thinking scientifically.
- One-word answers are fine. Answers must be in English; an explanation in Chinese scores 0.

6. Score summary

Candidate name	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	/ 8	A B C D E	
Reading paper	/ 24 (A / 8, B / 8, C / 8)	A B C D E	Where did the student stop at 12 minutes?
Sentence reading (shared record)	points / 72, reading age	indicative A B C D E	Meaning checks, fluency
Writing	/ 16 (content / 4, vocabulary / 4, grammar / 4, spelling and punctuation / 4)	A B C D E	Task chosen: 1 2
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	/ 30 (A / 10, B / 20, of which word problems / 6)	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Science	/ 10	1 2 3 4	NT: L:

Number problems against word problems: Section A ___ / 10 (___ %) and word problems ___ / 6 (___ %). If the word problem percentage is much lower, was the barrier English? (Tick if a word problem was solved after it was read aloud or given in Chinese.) ☐

Overall English band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** (the band most of the four skills sit in; name any skill that is two or more bands below the others)

Comments (strengths, gaps, NT topics, what support the student would need):

Assessor signature and date _____

Copy these results onto `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: assessor record

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Age today (years:months)	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Assessor	

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this record, a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening).

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"

Code	Error	Example
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (mark them, but do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said in the notes. Patterns in the notes (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in the record). Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Record ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood). The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is recorded ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Record

Level 1 (sentences 1 to 3)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
1	I can see a red bus.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
2	The cat sat on my bed.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
3	Dad has a big hat.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 2 (sentences 4 to 6)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
6	They like to play in the park.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 3 (sentences 7 to 9)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 4 (sentences 10 to 12)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 5 (sentences 13 to 15)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 6 (sentences 16 to 18)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 7 (sentences 19 to 21)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 8 (sentences 22 to 24)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 9 (sentences 25 to 27)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 10 (sentences 28 to 30)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 11 (sentences 31 to 33)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 12 (sentences 34 to 36)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Total points	/ 72
Reading age	
Actual age (years:months)	
Difference (reading age minus actual age)	
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	
Fluency rating (1 to 4)	
Patterns noticed	

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and

structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Copy to the Candidate Summary: total points, reading age, actual age, meaning checks, fluency, indicative band, one line on patterns.

Student interview and suitability record: Years 7 to 10

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (3 to 5 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___ (details on the sentence reading record)

2. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes: what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?	
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?	
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?	
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.	
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?	
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?	
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?	
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?	
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?	
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?	
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?	
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?	
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?	
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?	
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?	
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?	
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?	
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.	
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?	
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?	
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?	
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?		

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best. Use the evidence from the whole interview.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

4. Suitability

Rate each strand from what you saw and heard. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	
Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning).

Interviewer signature and date

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Candidate summary and decision

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Complete within two working days, from the assessor booklet, reading records, interview record, parent conversation and homeroom teacher reference. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (scores)	Band
Listening	Listening task ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation	**A B C D E**
Speaking	Interview (and picture talk, Years 1 to 3)	**A B C D E**
Reading	Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen book band _____ accuracy ____% questions ___ ; phonics words ___ / 40 ; letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 10: reading paper ___ / 24 (A ___ B ___ C ___)	**A B C D E**
Reading aloud	Sentence reading: points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative **A B C D E**
Writing	Writing task ___ / 16	**A B C D E**
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	**A B C D E**

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems	Word problems	Not yet taught (NT)	Language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**	___ / ___	___ / ___		
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**				

1 Well below expected, **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. Questions marked NT score 0; say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE (Year 10 assessor booklet, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

Assessor's comment on maths and science (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not):

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Student interview (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Head of section			
Admissions			
Outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			